



WINDOWS & DOORS

Care & Maintenance Guide

Proper care helps preserve the appearance, operation and long-term performance of your aluminium windows and doors.

This guide provides general recommendations for cleaning and maintaining aluminium frames, glass, tracks, seals and hardware supplied by Atelier.



01

GENERAL CARE

Simple Maintenance. Long-Term Performance.

Aluminium windows and doors are designed to provide durable, low-maintenance performance.

Like any building product exposed to weather, dust, moisture and everyday use, regular cleaning and inspection is important.

Routine maintenance helps:

- Preserve powdercoat finishes
- Keep tracks and drainage paths clear
- Maintain smooth operation
- Protect hardware and moving components
- Identify wear before it becomes a larger issue
- Maintain the overall appearance of the window or door system

Environmental conditions will affect how frequently cleaning is required.

Homes located near the coast, swimming pools, industrial areas, major roads or other corrosive environments may require more frequent maintenance.

02

RECOMMENDED MAINTENANCE SCHEDULE

Regular Care

As a general guide:

EVERY 3–6 MONTHS

- Wash aluminium frames
- Clean glass
- Remove dirt and debris from tracks
- Check drainage openings are clear
- Wipe down exposed hardware
- Inspect seals and weatherstripping
- Check doors and windows continue to operate smoothly

MORE FREQUENT CLEANING WHERE EXPOSED TO

- Coastal or salt environments
- Swimming pools
- Heavy traffic pollution
- Industrial fallout
- Construction dust
- High levels of airborne dirt or contaminants

Visible salt, dirt or contaminants should not be allowed to build up on aluminium surfaces.



03 ALUMINIUM FRAMES

Caring for Powdercoated Aluminium

Powdercoated aluminium requires relatively little maintenance, but regular washing is important to preserve the finish.

HOW TO CLEAN

1. Remove loose dust and dirt with clean water.
2. Wash the aluminium using warm water and a mild, pH-neutral detergent.
3. Use a soft cloth, sponge or soft-bristled brush.
4. Rinse thoroughly with clean water.
5. Dry with a clean, soft cloth where required.

DO NOT USE

Avoid:

- Abrasive cleaners
- Steel wool
- Scouring pads
- Metal scrapers
- Strong solvents
- Acidic or alkaline cleaners
- Aggressive chemical cleaning agents
- Thinners or paint removers
- Harsh household chemicals

These products may permanently damage the powdercoat finish.

04 COASTAL ENVIRONMENTS

Additional Care Near the Coast

Salt carried through the air can accumulate on aluminium, glass and hardware.

Properties in coastal environments should be washed more frequently to prevent salt and contaminants remaining on exposed surfaces for extended periods.

Particular attention should be given to:

- External aluminium frames
- Door tracks
- Hinges
- Locks
- Handles
- Rollers
- Drainage openings
- Areas sheltered from natural rainfall

Sheltered surfaces can sometimes require more attention than exposed surfaces because rainfall does not naturally wash contaminants away.

Regular rinsing with fresh water is recommended where salt deposits are visible.

05 GLASS Keeping Your Glazing Clear

Glass should be cleaned regularly using clean water and a suitable non-abrasive glass cleaner.

RECOMMENDED METHOD

Use:

- Clean water
- Mild detergent if required
- Soft, lint-free cloths
- Clean squeegees

Remove loose dirt before wiping the glass to reduce the risk of scratching.

AVOID

Do not use:

- Metal scrapers
- Razor blades without specialist knowledge
- Abrasive pads
- Highly alkaline cleaners
- Cement or mortar removal chemicals
- Harsh solvents

Special care should be taken with coated or performance glazing.

Where Low-E or other specialist glass coatings are present, avoid abrasive cleaning methods and follow any project-specific glass care instructions supplied.

06

CONSTRUCTION CONTAMINATION

Protect Windows During Building Work

Windows and doors are particularly vulnerable during construction.

Cement, mortar, render, plaster, paint, adhesives and metal grinding debris can permanently damage glass and powdercoated aluminium if allowed to remain on the surface.

DURING CONSTRUCTION

Windows and doors should be protected from:

- Cement slurry
- Mortar
- Render
- Grout
- Paint overspray
- Welding sparks
- Metal grinding particles
- Plaster
- Adhesives and sealants
- Aggressive cleaning chemicals

Any contamination should be removed carefully as soon as practicable.

Do not allow cementitious products or metal particles to dry onto aluminium or glass surfaces.

Protective films supplied on components are intended for temporary protection only and should be removed within the timeframe recommended for the applicable product.



07

TRACKS

Keep Tracks Clean

Sliding windows and doors rely on clean tracks for smooth operation.

Dust, sand, pet hair and construction debris can accumulate within the track and interfere with rollers and drainage.

REGULARLY

- Vacuum loose debris from tracks
- Wipe tracks using a damp cloth
- Remove sand, stones and other particles
- Check drainage openings remain unobstructed
- Inspect the track for unusual wear or damage

Do not force a sliding panel if it becomes difficult to operate.

Resistance may indicate debris, roller adjustment or another issue requiring attention.

08 DRAINAGE

Keep Water Paths Clear

Many window and door systems incorporate drainage openings designed to allow water to escape from the frame.

These openings must remain clear.

Periodically inspect visible drainage slots and remove:

- Dirt
- Leaves
- Insects
- Construction debris
- Sealant or other obstructions

Do not permanently seal or block drainage openings.

Water appearing within an external sill or track during heavy rain does not necessarily indicate a fault. These systems are designed to manage and discharge water through designated drainage paths.

09 HARDWARE

Handles, Locks, Hinges & Rollers

Hardware is subject to regular movement and may require periodic cleaning and adjustment.

Inspect:

- Handles
- Locks
- Hinges
- Rollers
- Stays
- Latches
- Restrictors
- Door closers, where applicable

Wipe exposed hardware with a soft damp cloth and remove dirt, salt or contaminants.

Moving components may occasionally require an appropriate lubricant.

Use only a lubricant suitable for the particular component and avoid excessive application, as excess lubricant can attract dust and debris.

Do not use excessive force when operating handles or locks.

If a component becomes difficult to operate, investigate the cause rather than forcing it.

10 SLIDING DOORS

Smooth Operation

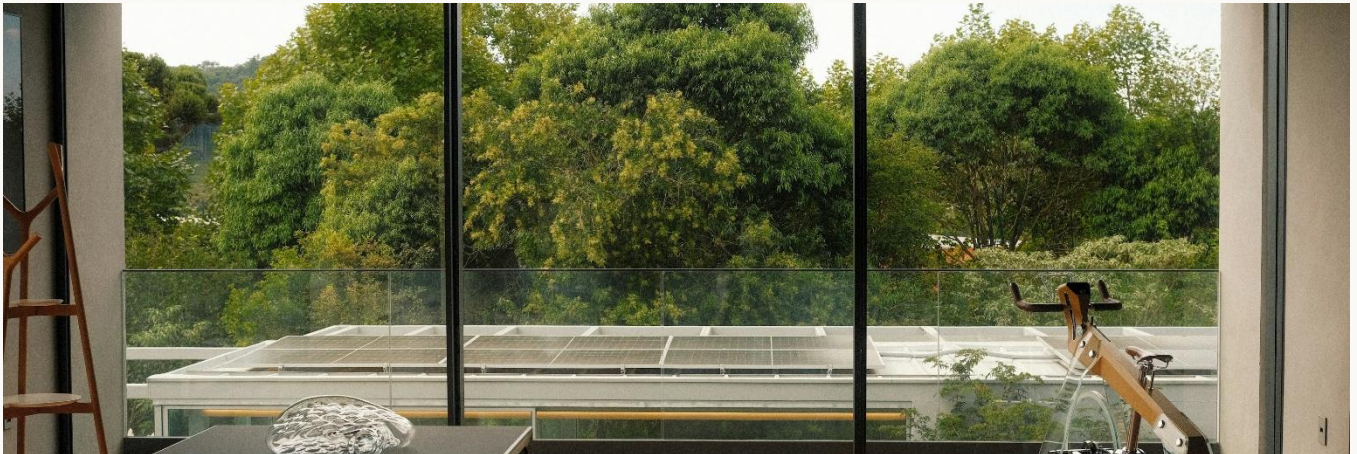
Large sliding and stacking doors rely on correctly maintained tracks and rollers.

To maintain operation:

- Keep the bottom track clean
- Remove sand and debris regularly
- Do not allow stones or hard objects to remain within the track
- Open and close panels using the intended handles
- Avoid slamming doors
- Do not force panels if resistance is felt
- Periodically check handles and locks

Over time, rollers may require adjustment as the building settles or components experience normal use.

Where significant adjustment is required, engage a suitably experienced installer or service technician.



11 AWNING & CASEMENT WINDOWS

Hinges, Stays & Operators

Awning and casement windows include moving hardware that should be kept clean and operating freely.

Periodically:

- Open the window fully where safe to do so
- Inspect hinges and stays
- Remove accumulated dirt
- Check screws and visible fixings
- Test handles and locks
- Confirm the sash closes evenly against the seals

Do not place excessive weight on an open sash or use the sash as a support.

Do not force the window beyond its designed opening position.

12 SEALS & WEATHERSTRIPPING

Maintaining the Building Envelope

Window and door systems may incorporate rubber seals, gaskets, brushes and weatherstripping.

These components help manage air and water around operable panels.

Periodically inspect seals for:

- Damage
- Movement
- Splitting
- Excessive wear
- Missing sections
- Dirt build-up

Clean using mild soapy water and a soft cloth.

Do not remove seals unnecessarily.

Damaged or displaced seals should be assessed and replaced where required.

13 SEALANTS Perimeter Joints

External sealants form an important part of the interface between the window or door and the surrounding building.

These joints should be periodically inspected for:

- Cracking
- Separation
- Shrinkage
- Loss of adhesion
- Physical damage

Sealants naturally weather over time and may require maintenance or replacement during the life of the building.

Where deterioration is identified, engage an appropriately experienced contractor.



14 CONDENSATION Understanding Condensation

Condensation can occur when warm, moisture-laden air contacts a sufficiently cold surface.

The presence of condensation does not automatically indicate that a window is leaking or defective.

Factors influencing condensation include:

- Indoor humidity
- Outdoor temperature
- Ventilation
- Heating and cooling
- Window surface temperature
- Occupancy
- Cooking and bathing

To help manage internal condensation:

- Provide adequate ventilation
- Use exhaust fans when cooking or bathing
- Avoid excessive indoor humidity
- Allow air to circulate around windows
- Use heating and cooling appropriately

Persistent or excessive condensation may warrant further investigation into indoor humidity and building ventilation.

15 THINGS TO AVOID

Protect Your Windows & Doors

To minimise unnecessary damage:

- Do not slam windows or doors
- Do not force handles or locks
- Do not use abrasive cleaning products
- Do not drill into frames without understanding the system
- Do not block drainage openings
- Do not paint over hardware, seals or drainage paths
- Do not allow construction materials to remain on frames or glass
- Do not modify window or door components without appropriate advice
- Do not hang loads from window or door frames
- Do not remove structural or operating hardware

Unauthorised modification can affect operation, weather performance and safety.

16 PERIODIC INSPECTION

Check Before There Is a Problem

A simple periodic inspection can identify maintenance requirements early.

Check that:

- Frames are clean and free from excessive contamination
- Glass is undamaged
- Tracks are clean
- Drainage openings are clear
- Windows open and close smoothly
- Sliding doors move freely
- Handles operate correctly
- Locks engage properly
- Hinges and stays are secure
- Rollers operate smoothly
- Seals remain in position
- External sealant remains intact
- There are no loose or damaged components

If something does not appear to be operating correctly, avoid forcing the component.

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WHEN TO SEEK ASSISTANCE

Some Items Require Professional Attention

Contact Atelier or an appropriately experienced contractor if you notice:

- Cracked or damaged glass
- Significant water entry
- Damaged frames
- Failed hardware
- Doors dropping or becoming difficult to operate
- Rollers requiring significant adjustment
- Damaged seals
- Deteriorated perimeter sealant
- Unusual movement or noise
- Components that no longer lock correctly

For safety, glass replacement and significant window or door adjustments should be undertaken by appropriately qualified or experienced trades.



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CARE AFTER INSTALLATION

A Good Handover Starts With a Clean Product

Following completion of building works, windows and doors should receive a thorough clean before occupation.

This should include:

- Removal of construction dust
- Cleaning aluminium surfaces
- Cleaning glass
- Vacuuming tracks
- Clearing drainage openings
- Checking handles and locks
- Inspecting seals
- Testing all operable panels

Any construction-related damage should be identified as early as possible.

19 QUICK MAINTENANCE GUIDE

Keep It Simple

FRAMES

Wash with fresh water and mild detergent.

TRACKS

Vacuum and wipe regularly.

HARDWARE

Clean and inspect moving components periodically.

COASTAL HOMES

Clean more frequently to remove salt deposits.

GLASS

Clean using non-abrasive glass cleaning products.

DRAINAGE

Keep openings free from debris.

SEALS

Check for wear, movement or damage.

OPERATION

Never force a window or door that is difficult to operate.

20 FINAL NOTE

Designed to Perform. Maintained to Last.

Your Atelier windows and doors form an important part of the architecture and building envelope of your home.

Regular cleaning, sensible operation and periodic inspection will help maintain their appearance and performance for years to come.

Care requirements can vary depending on the window system, hardware, glazing, location and environmental exposure.

Where project-specific product or manufacturer maintenance instructions have been provided, those requirements should be followed in conjunction with this guide.

NEED ASSISTANCE?

If you are unsure about the maintenance or operation of your Atelier windows and doors, contact our team with your project details and photographs of the relevant component.

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Atelier Supply Group
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